

Chapter 16: Chance Encounter

Feng Yue heard from Liu Ma that Yan Lin hadn't come home for three days, and she felt a long-lost sense of familiarity.

During this period, she had been following medical advice carefully, ensuring her mental state at all times. She had started learning how to edit videos online, so she put much less thought into Yan Lin.

Feng Yue roughly knew why Yan Lin wasn't coming home. She didn't want to argue with her, so she could only avoid her.

Feng Yue didn't mind. After all, she had already figured out how to get Yan Lin to agree to sign the divorce agreement; it just wasn't the right time yet.

Feng Yue's gaze fell on the vase not far in front of her, which contained beautiful, blooming roses.

These had been delivered this morning, but they weren't ordered by Feng Yue. Since she hadn't ordered them, the only possibility was that they were ordered by that person who had been avoiding her.

Flowers had been delivered for three consecutive days. Every morning, Liu Ma would receive a bouquet of fresh and beautiful roses. At first, she was also puzzled about who was sending them, but it didn't take long for her to figure it out.

This must be from the young miss¹.

Three days ago, the young miss had called her, asking her to move to the villa starting that day to take care of Feng Yue's daily needs, without having to leave after work.

She was naturally happy to do so, but it was also from that day that the young miss stopped coming home to sleep. Every time she asked about it, the response was that the company was busy.

Liu Ma had worked for the Yan family for almost twenty years and had watched Yan Lin grow up, so she could be considered half an elder. Her experience told her that the two children must have quarreled.

She couldn't mediate, so she could only tell this matter to Lady Yan at the old mansion.

Sure enough, a call came from the old mansion.

"Hello, Mom." Feng Yue was a bit surprised to answer the phone.

"Xiao Yue², tomorrow come home with A-Lin for dinner. Mom will make you something delicious." Lady Yan sounded very happy, with nothing unusual in her tone.

Feng Yue thought that she indeed hadn't seen the elders for quite some time, and her plan was roughly set for these next two days anyway, so she might as well move it up.

Feng Yue obediently replied: "Mom, the company has been a bit busy these days, and Yan Lin might not be able to get away. How about this - previously Shuangshuang³ took me to a Cantonese private kitchen that tasted pretty good. Let's gather as a family on Tuesday. I'll also call my parents. We also have something to tell you all."

Lady Yan felt much better hearing this and said: "That's fine, I haven't seen your mother for a long time either."

"Good."

"Alright, Mom is going to play mahjong⁴ now, won't disturb you anymore."

"Mom, goodbye."

Feng Yue hung up the phone and casually sent a message to Yan Lin, asking her to keep Tuesday free.

The other side didn't delay too long and quickly replied to Feng Yue. Feng Yue glanced at it, then put her phone on the table and went upstairs to get ready.

Today she still had to keep her appointment to watch Zhou Qiongqiong's dance drama.

Feng Yue returned to her bedroom and looked at the two tickets on the table, sighing.

She had said that by the time she went to watch the drama, she and Yan Lin would already be divorced. Now it seemed she had overestimated her execution ability.

Divorce was really giving her a headache.

Since the performance was in the afternoon, Feng Yue had also made dinner plans with Zhou Qiongqiong. Before leaving, she told Liu Ma that she wouldn't need dinner prepared for her that evening.

The driver dropped Feng Yue off at the theater entrance, and she queued up to have her ticket checked and entered.

Zhou Qiongqiong had been learning folk dance⁵ since childhood and later got into a good arts college in Yanjing. With heaven's blessing and her family's conditions, she joined her current dance troupe right after graduation and became a dance drama performer.

The spotlight fell on the stage, the curtain rose, and the performance began.

Feng Yue sat in the audience, watching Zhou Qiongqiong who was the center of attention on stage, with a hint of envy in her eyes.

She should also find something to do. Even if she couldn't be the center of attention like Zhou Qiongqiong, she should at least do something that could make her happy.

Her life had been stagnant for twelve years because of Yan Lin and had never moved forward. From now on, she should start moving forward.

She had already fallen too far behind everyone else. She shouldn't chase after Yan Lin anymore.

As time passed, the performance also came to an end. It wasn't until after the last curtain call by the lead performers that the troupe's staff found Feng Yue and took her backstage.

Zhou Qiongqiong in the dressing room hadn't removed her makeup yet and was enthusiastically discussing today's performance with her colleagues.

Feng Yue knocked on the door, and Zhou Qiongqiong looked over happily: "You're here! Wait for me a moment, I'll be OK once I remove my makeup."

Feng Yue walked forward and hugged her: "It was a wonderful performance, you were amazing."

"If you praise me like this, I might get shy."

"Stop being silly and hurry up with your makeup."

Zhou Qiongqiong smiled and sat back down to start removing her makeup, chatting with Feng Yue while doing so.

"I heard from the staff that flower baskets were delivered to the theater early this morning, without any message or anything. You sent them, right?"

Feng Yue was a bit surprised. She had specifically instructed the flower delivery staff not to reveal her information. How did Zhou Qiongqiong guess it was her?

"How did you guess it was me?"

Zhou Qiongqiong looked at her through the mirror in front of her with an "I knew it" expression: "What's so hard about that? Others send flowers like sunflowers or roses, but today's flower basket was full of roses⁶. Besides you, who else would send them like this?"

Feng Yue was stunned for a moment, then smiled: "You still remember that I like roses."

"Of course I remember. We even wrote in yearbooks⁷, didn't we? When asked 'favorite thing,' everyone wrote money, cars, watches, and such, but you wrote roses. How could I not remember? Also, on the day after the college entrance exam⁸, your mother brought a big bouquet of roses to celebrate with you. Everyone saw it."

Feng Yue smiled and said nothing more. Even a high school classmate who wasn't particularly close to her could notice that she liked roses, but Yan Lin, who had been with her for almost twelve years, sent her a bouquet of roses on their wedding anniversary.

How absurd.

"Feng Yue?" At this moment, a familiar female voice came from behind Feng Yue, interrupting her memories.

She turned around and saw Wen Zhen in a pure black spaghetti strap dress, her long hair casually tied behind her head with some strands hanging down on both sides of her cheeks.

"Sister Wen Zhen, what are you doing here?" Feng Yue was a bit surprised to encounter someone familiar backstage at the theater.

Zhou Qiongqiong looked at the newcomer through the mirror, then happily turned around and called out: "Senior Sister, you're here!"

As Zhou Qiongqiong's voice fell, others in the dressing room also noticed Wen Zhen and gathered around happily, chattering and calling her "senior sister."

Feng Yue was a bit confused. Wasn't she Dai Shuangshuang's friend and private kitchen owner? How did she become Zhou Qiongqiong and these performers' senior sister?

Wen Zhen was surrounded by everyone and quickly distributed the food she was carrying, then freed herself to return to the two of them.

Zhou Qiongqiong poured Wen Zhen a glass of water: "Senior Sister, I didn't expect you two to know each other."

"Wen Zhen-jie and I met at her restaurant. But you two..." Feng Yue looked curiously at the two of them.

"My mother is the troupe's boss and also their teacher. I learned dance for a while when I was little, so they jokingly call me senior sister."

Zhou Qiongqiong obviously disagreed with this explanation and intimately took Wen Zhen's arm: "Don't listen to her nonsense. Senior Sister is very talented, but she didn't like it so she didn't stay with the troupe."

Feng Yue nodded. No wonder she felt that Wen Zhen had an unusual aura when she first saw her. It turned out she studied dance.

"So Feng Yue, are you and Qiongqiong friends?" Wen Zhen asked.

Zhou Qiongqiong: "Sort of. We were in the same class in both middle school and high school, but we only started contacting each other frequently recently."

Feng Yue nodded beside them.

"Sister Wen Zhen, would you like to have dinner with us? Qiongqiong and I booked a table at Yuxiang Zhai⁹."

"Yes, yes, let's go! Yuxiang Zhai is so hard to book." Zhou Qiongqiong also extended the invitation.

Seeing this, it would be impolite for Wen Zhen not to nod, so she smiled and agreed: "Alright, I don't have anything else to do tonight anyway."

The three of them walked out of the theater together, and Feng Yue's phone rang.

She fell back a step to check the message and was a bit surprised to see who had sent it.

【Yan Lin: Are you free tonight? Let's have dinner outside.】

Feng Yue didn't know what she was planning, but she definitely wouldn't go.

【Feng Yue: Sorry, I already have plans tonight.】

Zhou Qiongqiong saw that Feng Yue hadn't caught up and turned around to call her: "Feng Yue, what are you doing? Hurry up."

"Coming." Feng Yue looked up and smiled at her, stuffed her phone back in her bag, and quickly caught up.

Feng Yue had been driven here by her driver, Zhou Qiongqiong lived near the theater so she hadn't driven either, and Wen Zhen was the only one among the three who had driven here, naturally becoming the driver.

It wasn't rush hour yet, so the roads weren't too congested. The three of them arrived at Yuxiang Zhai's entrance almost without any obstacles.

Yuxiang Zhai was one of Yanjing's top restaurants, so its interior decoration was naturally exquisite - magnificent and beautiful. Walking through the lobby, they entered a uniquely designed private dining area.

This area was built like a corridor, with artificial hills and ponds in the middle, and even a few small fish swimming in them.

The server led the three of them to their reserved private room, chatting and laughing along the way. But after turning a corner, Feng Yue noticed that Zhou Qiongqiong's joking voice suddenly stopped.

Feng Yue curiously looked up and saw none other than Yan Lin.

Moreover, Yan Lin was accompanied by a sweet and cute-looking girl.

Zhou Qiongqiong stood in place, secretly glancing at Feng Yue and then at Yan Lin across from them, her inner screaming almost lifting the top of her head.

What kind of battleground¹⁰ is this?! Did Feng Yue just witness Yan Lin's affair scene?!!

Actually, Zhou Qiongqiong's overthinking wasn't unreasonable, mainly because Yan Lin and that girl's actions seemed a bit too intimate.

But what Feng Yue was thinking as she stood there wasn't whether Yan Lin was having an affair, but that this girl looked somewhat familiar.

Before Feng Yue could figure it out, the girl across from them saw Feng Yue and her round almond eyes suddenly lit up.

The next second, she ran straight toward Feng Yue.

Footnotes:

- ¹ **Young miss (小姐):** A respectful term used by servants to address the daughter of their employers. In this context, Liu Ma is referring to Yan Lin.
- ² **Xiao Yue (小月):** An affectionate diminutive form of Feng Yue's name. "Xiao" is a prefix used to create intimate nicknames for younger people or those close to you.
- ³ **Shuangshuang (霜霜):** A nickname, likely referring to Fu Sixue (傅思雪), as "shuang" means frost and "xue" means snow, both related to cold/winter themes.
- ⁴ **Mahjong (麻将):** A traditional Chinese tile-based game commonly played by four players, very popular among middle-aged and elderly Chinese people as a social activity.
- ⁵ **Folk dance (民族舞):** Traditional Chinese ethnic dance forms that represent the cultural heritage of China's various ethnic groups.
- ⁶ **Translation note:** The original text mentions "月季" (yuèjì) which are actually Chinese roses or *rosa chinensis*, but in the context they are translated as "roses" for clarity, as this is Feng Yue's favorite flower and relates to her name "月" (moon).
- ⁷ **Yearbooks (同学录):** Chinese school friendship books where classmates write personal information and memories for each other, similar to Western yearbooks but more personal and intimate.
- ⁸ **College entrance exam (高考):** The Gaokao, China's national college entrance examination that determines university admission. It's one of the most important events in a Chinese student's life.
- ⁹ **Yuxiang Zhai (御香斋):** A fictional upscale restaurant name. "Yu" means imperial, "xiang" means fragrant, and "zhai" means residence or hall, suggesting an elegant, traditional Chinese dining establishment.
- ¹⁰ **Battleground (修罗场):** Originally a Buddhist term referring to a place of suffering, but in modern Chinese internet slang it refers to awkward situations involving romantic drama or confrontation between rivals.